

the two requirements that are to be fulfilled to set up your PayPal account – straightforward as they come. The system is essentially one where the two parties will never need to know each other's financial details, with the entire transactions taking place between the two mail ids. So far, so good. But how safe is it? Considering how easy all of this seems, it's easy to assume that PayPal lacks safety measures. It is, in fact, one of the most secure payment systems in the world. In addition to multiple anti-fraud teams and super secure checks, payment insurances and a few more assurances, we can safely say that if you just have to trust someone/something, you might as well trust PayPal with it. Some praise, that.

And you're most definitely aware of...

MasterCard

It forms a layer of interfacing between the accounts of the payer and payee. Essentially, that is about it. When you purchase goods or services from somebody (in person or online), and provide your details, the merchant's bank 'buys' the transaction from him at a discounted price – only after your details have been authenticated by the server, that is. Then, this bank (Bank A) calls upon MasterCard's interfacing service to ask for funds from the consumer's bank, say Bank B. Bank B then proceeds to check the request, and pays MasterCard on Bank A's behalf. MasterCard then pays off Bank A, minus the settlement fee. Everybody's happy. Except, maybe the banks – because surcharge is only good if it's paid to you.



Visa

Everything is precisely the same as above here – just Visa in place of MasterCard.

And here's India's domestic answer to that...



RuPay

RuPay was started by National Payments Corporation of India as a domestic alternative to the MasterCard/Visa duopoly. Being an in-house initiative, it undercuts both of those on processing and transaction charges, which basi-